

FULL-DAY EMERGENCY SUB PLANS

VOLUME 2

3
FULL DAYS
VOLUME 2

THREE WHOLE DAYS

Complete elementary sub plans for grades 3 to 5.
Not a worksheet. An entire day, from the first
bell to dismissal.

FULL
DAY

NO
PREP

READY
TO USE

TEACHER
FRIENDLY

- ✓ Three complete school days, arrival to dismissal
- ✓ Reading, writing, math and science every single day
- ✓ A minute-by-minute schedule the substitute can follow
- ✓ Time fillers, brain breaks and indoor recess included
- ✓ Full answer keys, and nothing to prepare



READING



WRITING



MATH



SCIENCE



TODAY'S PLAN	
8:00	ARRIVAL & MORNING WORK
9:00	READING
10:00	WRITING
11:00	MATH
12:00	LUNCH & RECESS
1:00	SCIENCE
2:00	SOCIAL STUDIES / LESSON
3:00	WRAP UP & DISMISSAL

From the
first bell to
dismissal! ♥

DIGITAL VECTOR

Grades 3-5 • 62 pages • digitalvector.com.au

How This Pack Works

START HERE

Most sub plans give a substitute one activity and hope. That works for a middle school teacher covering a single period. It does not work in an elementary classroom, where the substitute has the same thirty children from arrival until dismissal and has to fill **every minute** of it.

This is Volume 2. All three days are new. Each one covers reading, writing, math and an afternoon block, plus morning work, a morning meeting, transitions, and a closing reflection. Print it once, put it in a drawer, and you are covered for three more absences. Nothing here repeats Volume 1.

What each day contains

PAGES	WHAT IT IS	WHO IT IS FOR
1	Day at a Glance. The entire day in one table, with times, what happens, and which page the students need in front of them.	The substitute. Keep it.
1	Morning Work. Word work and a number warm-up for students to start on as they arrive.	Copy for students.
1	Morning Meeting and First Moves. The exact words to say, plus three phrases that hold a class you do not know.	The substitute. Keep it.
3	Reading block. A passage written for this pack, comprehension questions, and a go further page.	Copy for students.
2	Writing block. A model, a planning frame, and a draft page.	Copy for students.
3	Math block. A worked example, practice, and a challenge.	Copy for students.
2	Afternoon science. A content page and a task page.	Copy for students.
1	End of Day Reflection. What students tell the returning teacher about the day.	Copy for students.
2	Answer keys. Every answer worked out, with marking notes.	The substitute. Keep them.

SIXTEEN PAGES PER DAY. TWELVE TO COPY, FOUR TO KEEP.

That sounds like a lot until you remember it is an entire school day. A regular teacher gets through more than that before lunch.

Copy each day as one stapled packet. Hand it out in the morning and students work through it in order. That single decision removes most of the transitions where an unfamiliar class comes apart.

Substitute Quick Start

FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

If you have five minutes before the children arrive, read this page and nothing else. It is enough to run the day.

IN THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES

1. Find the Day at a Glance page for whichever day the teacher left. Put it on the desk and keep it there.
2. Check the packets are copied. If they are not, copy the Morning Work page first and the rest during morning work.
3. Write your name on the board.
4. Read the Morning Meeting script. Do not improvise the first minute.

The shape of every day in this pack

ROUGHLY	WHAT HAPPENS
Arrival	Morning work at desks. You take attendance while they work, which is exactly why it exists.
Morning meeting	Ten minutes. Introduce yourself, name the plan for the day, take two questions.
Morning blocks	Reading, then writing, then math. The heaviest thinking goes earliest on purpose.
After lunch	Twenty minutes of quiet reading, then the science block. Afternoons are calmer by design.
Last ten minutes	The End of Day Reflection sheet, then pack up.

THREE THINGS THAT MATTER MORE THAN THE LESSONS

Give a finish time, not a page count. "Pens down at ten past" works. "Finish page three" starts a negotiation.

Ask students to show you the routines. Where they line up, how they hand things in, what happens at recess. They know, they enjoy telling you, and it makes them your allies rather than your auditors.

Never threaten anything you cannot do. You are here for one day. "Your teacher will see this" is true and sufficient.

IF A CHILD ASKS SOMETHING YOU CANNOT ANSWER

"Write it down and put a star next to it, and your teacher will look at the starred ones." This is always true, always accepted, and genuinely useful to the teacher who comes back.

The Three Days

THE THREE DAYS

Days are numbered 4 to 6 so they sit alongside Volume 1 without clashing. Each is completely independent. You do not need Volume 1 to use this pack.

DAY	THEME	READING	WRITING	MATH
4	Talking Without Words	Informational text and citing evidence	Narrative writing	Place value and rounding
5	The Longest Journey	Informational text and using numbers	Instructions and procedure	Elapsed time and timetables
6	The Town That Moved	Informational text and weighing two sides	Opinion writing	Money and multi-step problems

The afternoon block

DAY	TOPIC	WHAT STUDENTS DO
4	Sound and vibration	Sort five statements true or false, explain the domino comparison, and work out why a shorter guitar string sounds higher.
5	Why we have seasons	Use two cities on the same day to disprove the idea that summer means being closer to the Sun.
6	Maps and settlement	Match five towns to the reason they are where they are, then work out why a town stays after its reason disappears.

WHICH DAY SHOULD I LEAVE?

A class you do not know at all: Day 1. The reading is the most engaging of the three and the math is the most straightforward.

You want work you can grade when you return: Day 2. The explanatory writing shows you clearly who can and cannot connect cause to effect.

A restless group, or a Friday: Day 3. The story pulls them in and the writing task has a low entry point.

Three days out in a row: Leave them in order. The subjects rotate so nothing feels repetitive.

Class Information

TEACHER • FILL THIS IN ONCE AT THE START OF THE YEAR

Complete this page once and it works for every absence after that. It answers the questions a substitute would otherwise have to interrupt a neighboring class to ask.

THE BASICS

My name and grade _____

Room number _____

Teach this day _____ Day _____ or any day from the index

Teacher next door _____

Office extension _____

THE DAY

Bell times _____

Recess and lunch _____

Specials today _____

Which, when, who takes them _____

Bathroom routine _____

Where the class lines up _____

Fire drill point _____

THE CHILDREN

Leave early or arrive late _____

Medical, allergies, medication _____

Who holds it and where _____

Accommodations _____

Seating, extra time, reader, movement breaks _____

Students who can help you _____

Genuinely the most useful line on this page _____

Anything else _____

Holding a Class You Do Not Know

SUBSTITUTE · KEEP THIS PAGE

YOU ARE NOT GOING TO WIN BY BEING STRICT

A class that does not know you will test where the edges are. That is normal, it is not personal, and it happens in the first twenty minutes. Nothing settles a room faster than being warm and completely clear about what happens next.

Say this instead of that

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Voices off, eyes here, and I will tell you what happens next."
"Who was talking?"	"I am waiting for one more table." Then wait. Naming a child hands them the room.
"Sit down NOW."	"I need everyone in a seat before I can start. Any seat that works."
"Because I said so."	"Your teacher left this for today, so this is what we are doing."
"You always do this."	"That is not going to work today. Try again." You cannot know what they always do.
"Stop it or else."	Never threaten what you cannot deliver. "Your teacher will see this" is enough.

Four moves that work in any elementary room

- **Pick one quiet signal in the first ten minutes.** Raising your hand and waiting works everywhere and needs no equipment. Teach it once while things are calm and it will work when they are not.
- **Count down instead of asking twice.** "Packets away in five, four, three..." moves a room faster than any instruction repeated.
- **Give the loud one a job.** Handing out packets, collecting work, holding the door. It is not a reward, it is redirection, and it works.
- **Narrate what is going right.** "Table three is ready." The rest of the room copies it within seconds and nobody has been told off.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES PROPERLY WRONG

If a child is hurt, distressed, or a situation is beyond a normal classroom problem, send two students to the office or the teacher next door. Do not leave the class. Do not try to manage it alone because you want to seem capable.

Write one line about it on the substitute's note at the back of this pack. One line. Not a report.

What Is on Every Page

EVERY PAGE IN THIS PACK

Twelve pages per day are copied for students. Four are kept by the substitute. This table tells you which is which without opening anything.

PAGE	WHAT IT IS	CONTENTS
1-7	Getting started	Cover, how the pack works, substitute quick start, the three days, class information template, holding a class you do not know, this page
8	Day 4 at a Glance	The whole day in one table. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
9-21	Day 4 student pages	Morning work, informational text and citing evidence, narrative writing, place value and rounding, sound and vibration, and the End of Day Reflection
10	Day 4 morning script	The words to say for the first twenty minutes. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
22-23	Day 4 answer keys	Every answer, with marking notes. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
24	Day 5 at a Glance	The whole day in one table. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
25-37	Day 5 student pages	Morning work, informational text and using numbers, instructions and procedure, elapsed time and timetables, why we have seasons, and the End of Day Reflection
26	Day 5 morning script	The words to say for the first twenty minutes. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
38-39	Day 5 answer keys	Every answer, with marking notes. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
40	Day 6 at a Glance	The whole day in one table. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
41-53	Day 6 student pages	Morning work, informational text and weighing two sides, opinion writing, money and multi-step problems, maps and settlement, and the End of Day Reflection
42	Day 6 morning script	The words to say for the first twenty minutes. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
54-55	Day 6 answer keys	Every answer, with marking notes. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
56-60	The filler banks	Time fillers, brain breaks, indoor recess, a fast finisher menu for students, and the substitute's note back
61-62	Reference	Standards alignment, terms of use and credits

THE FASTEST WAY TO USE THIS PACK

Photocopy the twelve student pages for one day as a single stapled packet. Put the four substitute pages on the desk. That is the entire preparation, and it takes about four minutes.

Day 4 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school's bells win. The **Page** column tells you which sheet the students need in front of them. Everything is in the order you will use it.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Students come in and start Morning Work at their desks. Take attendance while they work.	p. 9
8:50	Morning meeting	Read the script on the next page.	keep
9:05	Reading	Students read the passage, then the questions. This one reads aloud well.	p. 11-12
9:50	Go further	The secret code task. Paper only.	p. 13
10:05	Recess	Ask a student to show you where the class lines up.	—
10:25	Writing	A short story. Plan first, then draft.	p. 14-15
11:10	Math	Place value and rounding. Worked example together, then practice.	p. 16-17
12:00	Lunch	Line them up two minutes early.	—
12:45	Quiet reading	Twenty minutes with their own book.	—
1:05	Science	Sound and vibration. Read together, then the task.	p. 19-20
1:50	Specials or filler	If there is no special, use the Time Filler Bank.	back
2:35	Closing	End of Day Reflection sheet, then pack up.	p. 21
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work on the desk with the reflection sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut the Go Further page and quiet reading first. The math challenge can go too. Keep the closing reflection.

IF YOU FINISH EARLY

Every block has a Fast Finisher box on the student page. Beyond that, the Time Filler Bank near the back of this pack has fifteen activities that need nothing at all.

Morning Work

DO THIS QUIETLY AT YOUR DESK WHILE EVERYONE ARRIVES

You do not need to finish all of it. Start at the top and work down.

1. Word work

Write the missing letters, then use the finished word in a sentence of your own.

WORD WITH LETTERS MISSING	THE WHOLE WORD	MY SENTENCE
sign_l		
patt_rn		
rais_d		
mess_ge		
inv_nt		

2. Number warm-up

Fill in the missing number in each one.

	PROBLEM	ANSWER
1	What is 6×9 ?	
2	Round 47 to the nearest ten	
3	Round 328 to the nearest hundred	
4	What digit is in the tens place in 4,562?	
5	Write $3,000 + 400 + 20 + 6$ as one number	
6	Which is bigger: 2,910 or 2,901?	

3. One-minute challenge

Think of three ways people send a message without speaking out loud. Write them down. A wave counts.

4. READY TO GO?

Turn your page over and read quietly. If you do not have a book, invent a hand signal for three different messages and draw them.

Morning Meeting and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST TWENTY MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger to this class and they are testing the edges. Being warm and completely clear about what happens next is worth more than any rule you could announce.

Morning meeting, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning. My name is on the board. Your teacher is away today and left me a full plan, so nothing today is a surprise. Reading, writing and math before lunch. After lunch we are finding out how sound actually gets from one person to another, and it is not what most people think. I will get some of your names wrong. Correct me kindly.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO	
1	Write your name on the board and leave it there all day.
2	Read the script above exactly. A clear first minute buys you the whole morning.
3	Ask: <i>what is one thing this class always does in the morning?</i> Take two answers, then move on.
4	Point at the plan and name what happens before recess.
5	Hand out the reading pages and begin.

Three things that hold a class you do not know

INSTEAD OF	SAY THIS
"Stop talking."	"Voices off, eyes here, and I will tell you what happens next."
"Sit down."	"I need everyone in a seat before I can start. Take any seat that works."
"Who is being noisy?"	"I am waiting for one more table." Then wait. Do not name anyone.
"Because I said so."	"Your teacher left this for today, so this is what we are doing."

THE ONE SIGNAL TO TEACH THEM EARLY

Pick a quiet signal in the first ten minutes and use it all day. Raising your hand and waiting works in every classroom and needs no equipment. Tell them what it means once, use it once while things are calm, and it will work when things are not.

Reading: Fifteen Years Old, and Right

BEFORE YOU READ

This is a true story about a boy who invented something at fifteen that is still used all over the world today. Watch for what the adults around him got wrong.

Fifteen Years Old, and Right

A true story

- 1 Louis Braille was three years old when he picked up a sharp tool in his father's workshop in France and injured one eye. An infection spread to the other. By the age of five he could see nothing.
- 2 He was a clever child and his family found him a place at a school for blind students in Paris. There was a library. It had fourteen books.
- 3 The reason there were only fourteen was that reading for blind people at the time meant running a fingertip over enormous raised letters pressed into thick paper. Each book weighed as much as a small child. A single page held only a few sentences. Reading one line took so long that most students had forgotten the start of a sentence before they reached the end of it.
- 4 Worse, nobody could write it. Making the letters needed a heavy press. A blind student could read, slowly, but could never take a note, never write a letter, never answer back.
- 5 Then a soldier named Charles Barbier visited the school. He had invented a code of raised dots for soldiers to read messages at night without lighting a lamp, which would have given away their position. His system used twelve dots for each sound. It was clumsy and the army had rejected it.
- 6 Louis was twelve when he saw it. He understood immediately what the adults had missed: **dots were the right idea, and twelve was too many**. A fingertip cannot feel twelve dots at once without moving. Moving is what made it slow.
- 7 So he cut it down. He tried ten, then eight, and finally six: two dots across and three dots down, small enough that one fingertip could cover the whole thing without moving at all. Six dots can be arranged sixty-three different ways, which is more than enough for every letter, every number and every punctuation mark.
- 8 He finished it at fifteen. It could be written with a simple pointed tool and a piece of card, which meant that for the first time a blind person could write as well as read.
- 9 The school did not adopt it. The sighted teachers preferred the raised letters, because raised letters looked like proper writing to them. One headmaster banned it and burned the books. The students learned it anyway, in secret, at night.
- 10 Louis Braille died in 1852. His system was officially adopted by his old school two years later, and it is now used in almost every language on Earth.

Reading Questions

Answer in the space given. The paragraph numbers in the questions tell you exactly where to look.

1 How old was Louis when he lost his sight, and how did it happen? (par. 1)

2 Why did the school library have only fourteen books? (par. 3)

3 Paragraph 4 says something even worse than slow reading. What was it, and why did it matter so much?

4 What did Louis understand that the adults had missed? (par. 6)

5 Explain why six dots works better than twelve. (par. 6-7)

Think about a fingertip.

6 A headmaster banned the system and burned the books, and the students learned it anyway. What does that tell you about how good it was?

Reading: Go Further

GO FURTHER

TASK: YOUR OWN CODE

Braille uses **six dots in a rectangle**, two across and three down. Each dot is either raised or flat. Fill in your own code below by shading circles.

LETTER	MY DOT PATTERN	LETTER	MY DOT PATTERN
A		D	
B		E	
C		F	

1 Write a three-letter word using only your six letters, in your code. Swap with a partner and see if they can read it.

2 Six dots can be arranged sixty-three different ways. Why is that enough for a whole alphabet when there are only twenty-six letters?

THINK ABOUT IT

Braille has to be read with a fingertip that cannot move. Explain, in one or two sentences, why that is completely different from designing something to be read with your eyes.

FAST FINISHER

Design a signal you could send across a noisy playground without shouting and without anyone else understanding it. Explain how a friend would learn it.

Writing: Plan It

WRITING BLOCK • STEP 1, PLAN IT

TODAY YOU ARE WRITING

A short story. Write about a character who **has to get an important message to someone without speaking**. Maybe they are somewhere silent, maybe they are too far away, maybe someone is listening.

What a good one looks like

The library was the quietest place in the school and Nadia had four minutes. She could see Theo across the room at the far table with his headphones on. She could not shout and she could not walk over, because Mrs. Achebe was already watching her. So Nadia opened her notebook and wrote one word in letters big enough to read from across a room. Then she held it against the window of the shelf and waited. It took Theo two minutes to look up. When he did, he read it, went completely still, and stood up so fast his chair fell over.

Your plan

Notes only. Do not write sentences yet.

PART	YOUR NOTES
My character Name plus one detail	
The message	
Why they cannot speak	
How they send it	
What happens next	
One small detail I will include A sound, a color, or something someone does	

Writing: Write It

WRITING BLOCK • STEP 2, WRITE IT

Write your story in full sentences. Try to **show** how your character feels instead of naming the feeling. Do not write "she was worried." Write what she did.

BEFORE YOU HAND IT IN, CHECK THREE THINGS

Does your character actually get the message across? Did you include one small detail a reader could see or hear? Did you avoid naming feelings directly?

Math: Place Value and Rounding

MATH BLOCK · READ THIS TOGETHER

WHAT WE ARE DOING TODAY

Every digit in a number has a job, and its job depends on where it is standing. Move a digit one place to the left and it becomes worth ten times as much.

Worked example

What is each digit worth in 4,562?

THOUSANDS	HUNDREDS	TENS	ONES
4	5	6	2
4,000	500	60	2

Now rounding. To round 4,562 to the nearest hundred, look at the digit *after* the hundreds place. That is the 6 in the tens.

If it is 5 or more, round up. If it is 4 or less, round down. 6 is more than 5, so the hundreds digit goes from 5 to 6, and everything after it becomes zero.

4,562 rounds to 4,600

SUBSTITUTE: THE ONE THING TO SAY IF THEY ARE STUCK

Ask which two hundreds the number sits between, then which one it is closer to. Almost every rounding mistake disappears when students think about closeness instead of rules.

Try these two together

	QUESTION	WORKING	ANSWER
A	Round 372 to the nearest hundred.		
B	What is the 7 worth in 2,713?		

Math: Practice

Show your working. A right answer with no working is worth less than a wrong answer you can explain.

QUESTION	WORKING	ANSWER
1 Round 68 to the nearest ten.		
2 Round 245 to the nearest hundred.		
3 Round 1,850 to the nearest hundred.		
4 What is the 9 worth in 3,914?		
5 Write $6,000 + 300 + 70 + 1$ as one number.		
6 Which is bigger: 5,081 or 5,108? How do you know?		
7 A stadium holds 8,472 people. Round that to the nearest hundred, and to the nearest thousand.		
8 A number rounds to 400 when rounded to the nearest hundred. What is the smallest whole number it could be? What is the largest?		

MATH CHALLENGE

THE MYSTERY NUMBER

Use every clue to find one four-digit number. Cross out what it cannot be as you go.

CLUE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	WHAT I WORKED OUT
1	It is between 3,000 and 4,000	
2	The digit in the hundreds place is 7	
3	The tens digit is double the ones digit	
4	The ones digit is 4	

- 1

What is the mystery number?
- 2

Round your answer to the nearest hundred, and then to the nearest thousand.
- 3

Now write your own set of four clues for a different four-digit number. Swap with a partner.

FAST FINISHER

Write down the largest four-digit number you can make using the digits 3, 8, 1 and 6 once each. Then the smallest. Then the one closest to 5,000.

Science: How Sound Travels

BEFORE YOU READ

Louis Braille's system works by touch. This afternoon is about the sense he still had, and how it actually works.

- 1 Every sound starts with something **vibrating**. A guitar string moving back and forth, a drum skin shaking, the vocal cords in your throat. Nothing vibrating means no sound at all.
- 2 Here is the part people usually get wrong. The vibrating thing does not send sound flying across the room like a thrown ball. It pushes the air particles right next to it. Those particles bump into the ones next to them, which bump into the next ones, and so on all the way to your ear.
- 3 The air itself barely moves. Think of a line of dominoes: the pattern travels the whole length of the line, but each domino only moves a tiny distance. Sound is the pattern, not the air.
- 4 Inside your ear the arriving pattern makes your eardrum vibrate, and your brain turns those vibrations into what you hear.
- 5 Because sound needs particles to bump into each other, it travels **faster** when the particles are closer together. It moves faster through water than through air, and faster still through steel. This is why you can hear a train coming through the rail long before you hear it through the air.
- 6 And if there are no particles at all, sound cannot travel. Space is almost completely empty, so a huge explosion out there would arrive at your ear as complete silence.
- 7 Two things control what a sound is like. How **big** the vibration is decides how loud it is. How **fast** it vibrates decides how high or low the note is. Fast vibrations make a high note; slow ones make a low note. That is why a short guitar string sounds higher than a long one.

WORDS WORTH KNOWING

Vibrate to move quickly back and forth.

Particle a tiny piece of a material, far too small to see.

Eardrum the thin part inside your ear that vibrates.

Pitch how high or low a note sounds.

Science: How Sound Travels: Your Turn

TASK 1: TRUE OR FALSE

Write **T** or **F**, and give the paragraph number that proves it.

STATEMENT**T OR F****HOW I KNOW**

Sound can travel through empty space

Every sound starts with something vibrating

Sound travels faster through steel than through air

The air rushes across the room carrying the sound

A faster vibration makes a louder sound

1 Explain the domino comparison in paragraph 3 in your own words. What is the pattern, and what are the dominoes?

TASK 2: WORK IT OUT

A guitar has thick strings and thin strings. When you press a string against the neck you make the vibrating part shorter. Using paragraph 7, explain what happens to the note when you make a string shorter, and why.

FAST FINISHER

Put your fingers lightly on your throat and hum. Describe what you feel and explain it using the word vibrating.

End of Day Reflection

LAST TEN MINUTES

BEFORE YOU PACK UP

Fill this in on your own. Your teacher will read it tomorrow, so be honest. There are no wrong answers here.

1 One thing I learned today was...

2 One thing I found tricky was...

3 One thing I would like to try after today is...

4 Something my teacher should know about today:

This is for anything at all. Good or bad.

A NOTE TO WHOEVER IS READING THIS

Thank you for looking after our class today. Please write your name here so we know who to thank:

Answer Key: Literacy

READING QUESTIONS

1. Three when he was injured with a sharp tool in his father's workshop; completely blind by five after an infection spread to the other eye.

2. Because books used enormous raised letters pressed into thick paper. Each book weighed as much as a small child and a page held only a few sentences, so books were huge and hard to make.

3. Nobody could **write** it. Making the raised letters needed a heavy press, so a blind student could read but could never take a note or write a letter.

The key idea is that reading without writing is only half of literacy. Worth saying aloud if students only mention slowness.

4. That dots were the right idea but twelve was too many.

5. A fingertip cannot feel twelve dots at once without moving, and moving is what made it slow. Six dots fit under one fingertip, so the whole letter can be felt in one go.

Full credit needs the fingertip, not just "six is easier".

6. Open. Strong answers: it was so much better that students took a risk to use it; the people it was designed for could judge it better than the people who could see.

The second idea is the valuable one. Praise any student who reaches it.

GO FURTHER AND WRITING

Go further: Open. Question 2's answer: sixty-three is more than twenty-six, so there are spare patterns left over for numbers, punctuation and whole common words. Students often notice you could use spares as shortcuts, which is exactly what real braille does.

MARKING THE WRITING IN TEN SECONDS

Look for showing rather than telling. If a story says "he was scared", write "what did he do?" in the margin. That single question improves more student writing than any other.

IF YOU ONLY MARK ONE THING TODAY

Mark the writing. It is the only piece on the whole day that shows you how each student thinks, and it is the piece the returning teacher can act on fastest.

Everything else can be checked against this key in a few minutes, or simply stacked and left.

Answer Key: Math and Afternoon

MATH PRACTICE

ANSWER	WORKING
A 400	The tens digit is 7, so round up
B 700	The 7 is in the hundreds place
1 70	8 is 5 or more, so round up
2 200	The tens digit is 4, so round down
3 1,900	The tens digit is 5, so round up
4 900	The 9 is in the hundreds place
5 6,371	
6 5,108 is bigger	Same thousands, but 1 hundred beats 0 hundreds
7 8,500 to the nearest hundred; 8,000 to the nearest thousand	Watch for students who round twice in a row and get 9,000
8 Smallest 350, largest 449	Anything from 350 to 449 rounds to 400. 449 catches most students, who often answer 450.

Challenge: The number is **3,784**. Ones digit 4, tens digit double that is 8, hundreds is 7, thousands is 3. Rounded: **3,800** to the nearest hundred and **4,000** to the nearest thousand.

AFTERNOON BLOCK

Task 1: 1 **F** (par. 6, no particles means no sound). 2 **T** (par. 1). 3 **T** (par. 5). 4 **F** (par. 2-3, the air barely moves). 5 **F** (par. 7, faster vibration makes a *higher* note, not a louder one).

Q1. The dominoes are the air particles. Each one only moves a tiny distance and bumps the next. The pattern of bumping is what travels all the way across the room, not the particles themselves.

Task 2. The note gets **higher**. A shorter string vibrates faster, and faster vibrations make a higher note.

LEAVE THIS FOR THE TEACHER

Stack the day's work on the desk with the End of Day Reflection sheets on top. Those are the most useful thing the returning teacher will read.

Day 5 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school's bells win. The **Page** column tells you which sheet the students need in front of them. Everything is in the order you will use it.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Students come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they work.	p. 25
8:50	Morning meeting	Read the script on the next page.	keep
9:05	Reading	Students read the passage, then the questions.	p. 27-28
9:50	Go further	Mapping the journey.	p. 29
10:05	Recess	Ask a student where the class lines up.	—
10:25	Writing	Instructions. Plan first, then draft.	p. 30-31
11:10	Math	Elapsed time and reading a timetable.	p. 32-33
12:00	Lunch	Line them up two minutes early.	—
12:45	Quiet reading	Twenty minutes with their own book.	—
1:05	Science	Why we have seasons. Read together, then the task.	p. 35-36
1:50	Specials or filler	If there is no special, use the Time Filler Bank.	back
2:35	Closing	End of Day Reflection sheet, then pack up.	p. 37
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work on the desk with the reflection sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut quiet reading and the math challenge first. If the writing block is going well let it run long and do the math practice page only.

IF YOU FINISH EARLY

Every block has a Fast Finisher box on the student page. Beyond that, the Time Filler Bank near the back of this pack has fifteen activities that need nothing at all.

Morning Work

DO THIS QUIETLY AT YOUR DESK WHILE EVERYONE ARRIVES

You do not need to finish all of it. Start at the top and work down.

1. Word work

Write the missing letters, then use the finished word in a sentence of your own.

WORD WITH LETTERS MISSING	THE WHOLE WORD	MY SENTENCE
journ_y		
migr_te		
dist_nce		
rou_e		
seas_n		

2. Number warm-up

Fill in the missing number in each one.

	PROBLEM	ANSWER
1	How many minutes in 2 hours?	
2	From 3:15 to 3:50 is ____ minutes	
3	45 minutes after 11:30 is ____	
4	How many hours in 3 days?	
5	$9 \times 7 =$ ____	
6	Half of 250 is ____	

3. One-minute challenge

Write down the longest journey you have ever made. Where from, where to, and roughly how long did it take?

4. READY TO GO?

Turn your page over and read quietly. If you do not have a book, draw a bird and label three things that help it fly a long way.

Morning Meeting and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST TWENTY MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger to this class and they are testing the edges. Being warm and completely clear about what happens next is worth more than any rule you could announce.

Morning meeting, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning. My name is on the board. Your teacher is away today and left me everything we need, so nothing today is a surprise. Reading, writing and math before lunch. After lunch we are finding out why we have seasons, and I will warn you now that most adults get this one wrong. I will get some of your names wrong too. Correct me kindly.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO	
1	Write your name on the board and leave it there.
2	Read the script above exactly.
3	Ask: <i>what does this class always do before starting work?</i> Two answers, then move on.
4	Point at the plan and name what happens before recess.
5	Hand out the reading pages and begin.

Three things that hold a class you do not know

INSTEAD OF	SAY THIS
"Stop talking."	"Voices off, eyes here, and I will tell you what happens next."
"Sit down."	"I need everyone in a seat before I can start. Take any seat that works."
"Who is being noisy?"	"I am waiting for one more table." Then wait. Do not name anyone.
"Because I said so."	"Your teacher left this for today, so this is what we are doing."

THE ONE SIGNAL TO TEACH THEM EARLY

Pick a quiet signal in the first ten minutes and use it all day. Raising your hand and waiting works in every classroom and needs no equipment. Tell them what it means once, use it once while things are calm, and it will work when things are not.

Reading: The Bird That Follows Summer

BEFORE YOU READ

This is a true story about a bird that makes the longest journey of any animal on Earth. As you read, keep track of the numbers. There are some very big ones.

The Bird That Follows Summer

A true story

- 1 The Arctic tern is not an impressive bird to look at. It weighs about as much as a tennis ball. It is white and grey, with a black cap and a red beak, and it would fit comfortably in your two hands.
- 2 Every year it flies from the Arctic to Antarctica and back again.
- 3 That is roughly 44,000 miles in a single year, and terns do not fly in a straight line. They follow the wind, looping out across the ocean and back, because fighting a headwind for thousands of miles would cost more energy than the extra distance does.
- 4 An Arctic tern can live for more than thirty years. Over a lifetime, one bird flies far enough to reach the Moon and come back. Then go most of the way there again.
- 5 The reason it does this is simple, once you see it. The Arctic has summer while Antarctica has winter, and Antarctica has summer while the Arctic has winter. Summer means long days and plenty of fish. By flying from one end of the world to the other, the tern lives in almost permanent summer. It sees more daylight in a year than any other creature alive.
- 6 For a long time nobody knew the route. The birds vanished in autumn and reappeared in spring, and following them was impossible.
- 7 That changed when scientists built a tracking device small enough to matter. The tag they fitted to the terns weighed 1.4 grams, less than a paperclip. Any heavier and it would have changed the journey it was supposed to measure.
- 8 The results surprised everyone. The birds traveled far further than the straight-line distance suggested, and they made long, unexplained stops in the middle of the Atlantic. Scientists later worked out that those stops were over patches of ocean unusually full of food, where the terns were refueling.
- 9 The tern does not carry a map. Nobody teaches it the route. A young tern makes its first journey without ever having seen it, using the position of the Sun, the pattern of the stars, and the Earth's magnetic field.

Reading Questions

Answer in the space given. The paragraph numbers in the questions tell you exactly where to look.

1 How big is an Arctic tern? Use the comparison from the text. (par. 1)

2 How far does one tern fly in a year, and why is it further than a straight line? (par. 3)

3 Explain in your own words why the tern makes this journey at all. (par. 5)

4 Why did the tracking tag have to weigh only 1.4 grams? (par. 7)

Think about what the scientists were trying to measure.

5 What surprised the scientists about the results, and how did they explain it? (par. 8)

6 Paragraph 9 says a young tern makes its first journey without ever having seen it. What does the text say it uses instead?

GO FURTHER

TASK: THE NUMBERS

Use the passage to fill this in. Show your working in the last column where you need to.

QUESTION	ANSWER	WORKING
Miles flown in one year		
Miles flown in two years		
Roughly how many miles in ten years		
How much does the tracking tag weigh?		
How long can an Arctic tern live?		

1 The Moon is about 239,000 miles away. Roughly how many years of flying would it take a tern to cover that distance?

THINK ABOUT IT

The terns fly further than they need to, by looping out with the wind instead of going straight. Explain why the longer route can actually be the easier one.

FAST FINISHER

Write five questions you would ask a scientist who studies Arctic terns. Then choose the one you most want answered and say why.

Writing: Plan It

WRITING BLOCK • STEP 1, PLAN IT

TODAY YOU ARE WRITING

Instructions. Write a clear set of instructions telling someone **how to do something you already know how to do**. Tying a shoelace, making toast, getting to the school office, or playing a game you know well.

What a good one looks like

How to make toast. 1. Take one slice of bread from the bag and close the bag again. 2. Put the slice into one slot of the toaster, standing up, not lying down. 3. Turn the dial to number three. If your toaster has no dial, skip this step. 4. Push the lever down until it clicks and stays. 5. Wait. Do not press the lever again, because it will not go faster. 6. When the toast pops up, take it out by the corner. It will be hot in the middle even if the corner feels cool.

Your plan

Notes only. Do not write sentences yet.

PART	YOUR NOTES
What I am explaining how to do	
What you need first	
Step 1	
Middle steps Notes only	
Last step	
One warning I should include	

Math: Elapsed Time

MATH BLOCK • READ THIS TOGETHER

WHAT WE ARE DOING TODAY

Elapsed time means how long something took. You will use it every day of your life, and it trips people up because clocks count in sixties, not tens.

Worked example

A flight leaves at 9:40 a.m. and lands at 1:15 p.m. How long was the flight?

Do not subtract. Count forward in easy jumps.

FROM	TO	JUMP
9:40	10:00	20 minutes
10:00	1:00	3 hours
1:00	1:15	15 minutes

Now add the jumps: 3 hours, plus 20 + 15 = 35 minutes.

3 hours 35 minutes

Jumping to the next whole hour first is the trick. It turns a hard subtraction into three easy additions.

SUBSTITUTE: THE ONE THING TO SAY IF THEY ARE STUCK

Draw a number line on paper and mark the jumps. Students who cannot do it in their heads can nearly always do it on a line.

Try these two together

	QUESTION	WORKING	ANSWER
A	From 10:20 a.m. to 12:05 p.m. How long?		
B	A movie starts at 2:45 and runs 1 hour 40 minutes. When does it end?		

Math: Practice

Show your working. A right answer with no working is worth less than a wrong answer you can explain.

QUESTION	WORKING	ANSWER
1 From 8:15 to 9:00. How many minutes?		
2 From 11:30 a.m. to 2:00 p.m. How long?		
3 A lesson starts at 1:20 and lasts 45 minutes. When does it end?		
4 From 7:50 a.m. to 10:25 a.m. How long?		
5 A bus leaves at 6:40 a.m. and the trip takes 2 hours 50 minutes. When does it arrive?		
6 Recess is 10:05 to 10:25. Lunch is 12:00 to 12:45. How many minutes of break altogether?		
7 A tern flies for 9 hours 30 minutes, rests for 2 hours 45 minutes, then flies 6 hours 15 minutes. Total time?		
8 School runs 8:30 a.m. to 2:50 p.m. How long is the school day?		

Math: Challenge

MATH CHALLENGE

THE TERN'S TIMETABLE

A tracked tern's journey, recorded in stages. Work out how long each stage took, then answer the questions.

STAGE	LEFT AT	ARRIVED AT	HOW LONG?
Arctic to Iceland	6:15 a.m.	11:45 a.m.	
Iceland to open ocean	1:30 p.m.	7:05 p.m.	
Ocean feeding stop	7:05 p.m.	4:20 a.m.	

1 How long did the bird rest in Iceland, between arriving and leaving again?

2 Which took longer, the two flying stages added together, or the feeding stop? Show your working.

FAST FINISHER

Work out how many minutes you have been at school today so far. Then how many are left until dismissal.

Science: Why We Have Seasons

BEFORE YOU READ

The tern flies between two opposite summers. This afternoon is about why the two ends of the Earth have opposite seasons at all. Most adults get this wrong.

- 1 Ask most people why summer is hot and they will say the Earth is closer to the Sun. It sounds sensible, and it is wrong.
- 2 Here is how we know. When it is winter in New York, it is summer in Sydney, on the same day. Both cities are on the same planet, at the same distance from the Sun. Distance is one number for the whole Earth at any moment, so it cannot possibly make one place hot and another place cold at the same time.
- 3 The real reason is **tilt**. The Earth is tipped over slightly, like a spinning top leaning to one side, and it stays leaning the same way all year as it travels around the Sun.
- 4 For half of the year, the top half of the Earth leans toward the Sun. For the other half, it leans away. The bottom half does the exact opposite at the same time. That is why the seasons are always swapped between the two halves.
- 5 Leaning toward the Sun does two things at once, and you need both to explain summer.
- 6 First, the sunlight arrives at a **steeper angle**, so the same amount of light is squeezed onto a smaller patch of ground instead of being smeared across a wide one. Try it with a torch: shine it straight down and you get a small bright circle. Tilt it and the same light spreads out and goes dim.
- 7 Second, the **days are longer**. So that more concentrated sunlight also arrives for more hours.
- 8 More energy per patch, for more hours a day. That is summer. And at the far north in midsummer, the Sun barely sets at all, which is exactly what the Arctic tern flies all that way to find.

WORDS WORTH KNOWING

Tilt to lean to one side.

Angle how slanted something is.

Concentrated packed into a smaller space.

Hemisphere one half of the Earth, top or bottom.

Science: Why We Have Seasons: Your Turn

TASK 1: SAME DAY, OPPOSITE SEASONS

All of these were recorded on the **same day**, 21 December. Use them to answer the questions.

CITY	HALF OF EARTH	DAYLIGHT HOURS	SEASON
Chicago, USA	Top	9.1	Winter
Sydney, Australia	Bottom	14.4	Summer

1 On that day, is Chicago further from the Sun than Sydney? Think carefully before you answer.

2 Use your answer to explain why "we are closer to the Sun in summer" cannot be right.

3 Name the two things that happen when your half of the Earth leans toward the Sun. You need both.

TASK 2: THE TORCH TEST

Paragraph 6 describes shining a torch straight down and then tilting it. Draw both, and label which one is like summer and which is like winter.

FAST FINISHER

Explain, in two sentences, why the Arctic tern's journey only makes sense because the two ends of the Earth have opposite seasons.

End of Day Reflection

LAST TEN MINUTES

BEFORE YOU PACK UP

Fill this in on your own. Your teacher will read it tomorrow, so be honest. There are no wrong answers here.

1 One thing I learned today was...

2 One thing I found tricky was...

3 One thing I want to find out more about is...

4 Something my teacher should know about today:

This is for anything at all. Good or bad.

A NOTE TO WHOEVER IS READING THIS

Thank you for looking after our class today. Please write your name here so we know who to thank:

Answer Key: Literacy

READING QUESTIONS

1. It weighs about as much as a tennis ball and would fit in your two hands.
2. About 44,000 miles a year. It is further than a straight line because terns follow the wind, looping out across the ocean, since fighting a headwind would cost more energy than the extra distance.
3. The Arctic and Antarctica have opposite seasons, so by flying between them the tern lives in almost permanent summer, which means long days and plenty of fish.
4. Because a heavier tag would have changed the journey the scientists were trying to measure. The bird would have flown differently, so the results would not have been true.
This is the strongest question on the page. It is about not disturbing what you are measuring.
5. The birds flew much further than the straight-line distance, and made long stops in the middle of the Atlantic. Scientists worked out the stops were over patches of ocean full of food, where the terns were refueling.
6. The position of the Sun, the pattern of the stars, and the Earth's magnetic field.

GO FURTHER AND WRITING

Go further: One year 44,000 miles. Two years 88,000. Ten years about 440,000. Tag 1.4 grams. Lifespan more than thirty years. The Moon at 239,000 miles would take roughly **five and a half years** of flying. For the wind question, look for the idea that effort matters more than distance.

MARKING THE WRITING IN TEN SECONDS

The test is whether a step is missing. Read the instructions as though you know nothing at all, and the gap will jump out. Most students skip the very first step, because it is so obvious to them that they forget it exists.

IF YOU ONLY MARK ONE THING TODAY

Mark the writing. It is the only piece on the whole day that shows you how each student thinks, and it is the piece the returning teacher can act on fastest.

Everything else can be checked against this key in a few minutes, or simply stacked and left.

Answer Key: Math and Afternoon

MATH PRACTICE

	ANSWER	WORKING
A	1 hour 45 minutes	10:20 to 12:00 is 1h 40, plus 5
B	4:25	$2:45 + 1\text{h} = 3:45$, + 40 min = 4:25
1	45 minutes	
2	2 hours 30 minutes	11:30 to 12:00 is 30, then 2 hours
3	2:05	$1:20 + 40 = 2:00$, + 5 = 2:05
4	2 hours 35 minutes	7:50 to 8:00 is 10, then 2h, then 25
5	9:30 a.m.	$6:40 + 2\text{h} = 8:40$, + 50 min = 9:30
6	65 minutes	$20 + 45$
7	18 hours 30 minutes	$9\text{h}30 + 2\text{h}45 + 6\text{h}15$
8	6 hours 20 minutes	8:30 to 2:30 is 6h, plus 20 min

Challenge: Stages: Arctic to Iceland **5 hours 30 minutes**. Iceland to ocean **5 hours 35 minutes**. Feeding stop **9 hours 15 minutes**. **1.** Rested in Iceland 1 hour 45 minutes (11:45 to 1:30). **2.** Flying totals 11 hours 5 minutes, which is longer than the 9 hour 15 minute feeding stop, by 1 hour 50 minutes.

AFTERNOON BLOCK

Q1. No. They are essentially the same distance. Both are on the same planet, and the width of the Earth is tiny compared with the 93 million miles to the Sun.

Q2. Because both cities are the same distance from the Sun on the same day and are having opposite seasons. One distance cannot cause two different results.

Q3. 1. Sunlight arrives at a steeper angle, so it is concentrated onto a smaller patch of ground. **2.** The days are longer, so that concentrated light arrives for more hours. Both halves are needed for full credit.

Task 2. Torch straight down makes a small bright circle, which is like summer. Torch tilted spreads the same light over a wider, dimmer area, which is like winter.

LEAVE THIS FOR THE TEACHER

Stack the day's work on the desk with the End of Day Reflection sheets on top. Those are the most useful thing the returning teacher will read.

Day 6 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school's bells win. The **Page** column tells you which sheet the students need in front of them. Everything is in the order you will use it.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Students come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they work.	p. 41
8:50	Morning meeting	Read the script on the next page.	keep
9:05	Reading	Students read the passage, then the questions.	p. 43-44
9:50	Go further	The relocation decision task.	p. 45
10:05	Recess	Ask a student where the class lines up.	—
10:25	Writing	An opinion piece. Plan first, then draft.	p. 46-47
11:10	Math	Money, decimals and multi-step problems.	p. 48-49
12:00	Lunch	Line them up two minutes early.	—
12:45	Quiet reading	Twenty minutes with their own book.	—
1:05	Social studies	Maps, and why towns are where they are.	p. 51-52
1:50	Specials or filler	If there is no special, use the Time Filler Bank.	back
2:35	Closing	End of Day Reflection sheet, then pack up.	p. 53
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work on the desk with the reflection sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut quiet reading and the math challenge first. The Go Further page can also go, though it is one of the best tasks in the pack if you have time for it.

IF YOU FINISH EARLY

Every block has a Fast Finisher box on the student page. Beyond that, the Time Filler Bank near the back of this pack has fifteen activities that need nothing at all.

Morning Work

DO THIS QUIETLY AT YOUR DESK WHILE EVERYONE ARRIVES

You do not need to finish all of it. Start at the top and work down.

1. Word work

Write the missing letters, then use the finished word in a sentence of your own.

WORD WITH LETTERS MISSING	THE WHOLE WORD	MY SENTENCE
vall_y		
harb_ur		
settl_		
min_ral		
reloc_te		

2. Number warm-up

Fill in the missing number in each one.

	PROBLEM	ANSWER
1	$\$2.50 + \$3.25 = \underline{\hspace{1cm}}$	
2	$\$10.00 - \$4.35 = \underline{\hspace{1cm}}$	
3	Four items at \$1.50 each cost _____	
4	How many cents in \$3.07?	
5	Write 4.6 as a fraction with 10 on the bottom	
6	Which is more: \$5.09 or \$5.90?	

3. One-minute challenge

Write down three reasons a town might be built in one place rather than another. Think about water, food and travel.

4. READY TO GO?

Turn your page over and read quietly. If you do not have a book, draw a map of your route from home to school and label four things on it.

Morning Meeting and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST TWENTY MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger to this class and they are testing the edges. Being warm and completely clear about what happens next is worth more than any rule you could announce.

Morning meeting, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning. My name is on the board. Your teacher is away today and left a full plan, so nothing today is a surprise. Reading, writing and math before lunch. This afternoon is social studies, and it starts with a question: why is your town where it is, instead of a mile down the road? There is a real reason. I will get some of your names wrong. Correct me kindly.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO	
1	Write your name on the board and leave it there.
2	Read the script above exactly.
3	Ask: <i>what is one routine this class always does?</i> Two answers, then move on.
4	Point at the plan and name what happens before recess.
5	Hand out the reading pages and begin.

Three things that hold a class you do not know

INSTEAD OF	SAY THIS
"Stop talking."	"Voices off, eyes here, and I will tell you what happens next."
"Sit down."	"I need everyone in a seat before I can start. Take any seat that works."
"Who is being noisy?"	"I am waiting for one more table." Then wait. Do not name anyone.
"Because I said so."	"Your teacher left this for today, so this is what we are doing."

THE ONE SIGNAL TO TEACH THEM EARLY

Pick a quiet signal in the first ten minutes and use it all day. Raising your hand and waiting works in every classroom and needs no equipment. Tell them what it means once, use it once while things are calm, and it will work when things are not.

Reading: Moving a Town

BEFORE YOU READ

This is a true story about a whole town that is being picked up and moved, building by building. As you read, look for the reason, and for what the people there disagree about.

Moving a Town

A true story

- 1 Kiruna is a town in the far north of Sweden, well inside the Arctic Circle. Around eighteen thousand people live there. In midwinter the Sun does not rise for weeks.
- 2 The town exists because of what is underneath it. Kiruna sits on top of one of the largest deposits of iron ore in the world. The mine came first, in 1900. The town was built around it, for the miners and their families.
- 3 For over a hundred years that worked well. Then it stopped working, for a reason nobody could argue with.
- 4 Mining iron means digging out enormous quantities of rock. As the mine went deeper and wider, the ground above it began to crack and sink. Engineers measured the movement and worked out that the cracks were heading directly toward the town. Not quickly. But certainly, and without any way of stopping it.
- 5 The town had two choices. Close the mine, which employed most of the town, or move the town.
- 6 They decided to move the town.
- 7 The plan began in 2004 and is still going. The new town center is about two miles east of the old one. Most buildings are being demolished and rebuilt, because moving a building is far more expensive than replacing it.
- 8 But not all of them. Around twenty buildings that the town decided it could not lose were lifted onto enormous wheeled platforms and driven, very slowly, to the new site. The wooden church, which the people of Kiruna had once voted the most beautiful building in Sweden, was moved in one piece in 2025. It traveled at a walking pace and took two days.
- 9 Not everyone agrees it was the right decision. Some people say a home is a building and a street and a view, and that a rebuilt copy is not the same thing. Others point out that without the mine there would be no town at all, and no jobs to stay for.
- 10 Both groups are right about something, and that is usually what makes a decision hard.

Reading Questions

Answer in the space given. The paragraph numbers in the questions tell you exactly where to look.

1 Why does Kiruna exist at all? What came first, the town or the mine? (par. 2)

2 What went wrong, and why could nobody stop it? (par. 4)

3 What were the town's two choices, and which did they pick? (par. 5-6)

4 Most buildings are being rebuilt rather than moved. Why? (par. 7)

5 Some buildings were moved anyway. What does that tell you about how the town felt about them? (par. 8)

6 Paragraph 10 says both groups are right about something. Explain what each side is right about.

This is the most important question on the page.

Reading: Go Further

GO FURTHER

TASK: YOU DECIDE

Imagine you are on the town council. You have enough money to move **only three** buildings in one piece. Everything else will be demolished and rebuilt. Rank these from 1 (definitely move) to 6 (rebuild it).

BUILDING	RANK	WHY YOU RANKED IT THERE
The 100-year-old wooden church		
The hospital		
The elementary school		
The town hall clock tower		
A row of twenty family homes		
The supermarket		

1 Which was hardest to decide, and why?

THINK ABOUT IT

Some buildings are useful and some are important. Are those the same thing? Explain your answer in two sentences.

FAST FINISHER

Write the short speech you would give to the people of Kiruna on the day the church was moved. Three or four sentences.

Writing: Plan It

WRITING BLOCK • STEP 1, PLAN IT

TODAY YOU ARE WRITING

An opinion piece. **Should Kiruna have moved the town, or closed the mine?** Pick a side and argue it. You must include what the other side would say.

What a good one looks like

I think Kiruna made the right choice. The mine is the only reason the town is there at all, and paragraph 9 says most people work in it. If they had closed the mine, people would have had to leave to find jobs anyway, so the town would have emptied out even though the buildings were still standing. Some people say a rebuilt town is not the same as the real one, and I think that is true and sad. But an empty town with the original buildings is not the real town either. A town is the people in it.

Your plan

Notes only. Do not write sentences yet.

PART	YOUR NOTES
My opinion One sentence. No "maybe".	
Reason 1	
Proof from the text	
Reason 2	
The other side's best point Their strongest, not their weakest	
My answer to them	

Math: Money and Multi-Step Problems

MATH BLOCK · READ THIS TOGETHER

WHAT WE ARE DOING TODAY

Moving a town costs money. So does a school trip. Today's problems need more than one step, which means the hard part is working out what to do first.

Worked example

A class of 24 students goes on a trip. Tickets cost \$6.50 each. The bus costs \$84.00 for the whole class. What is the total cost?

Two steps. Do not try to do it in one.

STEP	WHAT TO WORK OUT	ANSWER
1	Cost of all the tickets: $24 \times \$6.50$	\$156.00
2	Add the bus: $\$156.00 + \84.00	\$240.00

The trick with money: keep the decimal points lined up underneath each other when you add or subtract. \$156.00 and \$84.00 line up as 156.00 and 084.00.

SUBSTITUTE: THE ONE THING TO SAY IF THEY ARE STUCK

Ask: *what do you need to know first, before you can answer the question?* That single question unlocks nearly every multi-step problem at this level.

Try these two together

	QUESTION	WORKING	ANSWER
A	6 tickets at \$4.25 each. Total?		
B	You have \$20.00 and spend \$13.45. Change?		

Math: Practice

Show your working. A right answer with no working is worth less than a wrong answer you can explain.

QUESTION	WORKING	ANSWER
1 $\$3.40 + \$2.85 = ?$		
2 $\$15.00 - \$6.75 = ?$		
3 Five notebooks at \$2.20 each. Total?		
4 You have \$10. You buy 3 pens at \$1.75 each. How much is left?		
5 A jacket costs \$38.99. In a sale it is \$10 off. New price?		
6 Four friends share a \$27.60 bill equally. How much each?		
7 A trip costs \$9.75 per student. There are 28 students. What is the total?		
8 The school raised \$500. It spends \$186.40 on books and \$212.75 on sports gear. How much is left?		

Math: Challenge

MATH CHALLENGE

THE MOVING BUDGET

A town council has \$900,000 to spend moving buildings. Work out what they can afford.

BUILDING	COST TO MOVE	RUNNING TOTAL IF WE MOVE IT
The wooden church	\$420,000	
The clock tower	\$185,000	
The old schoolhouse	\$260,000	
The train station	\$340,000	

1 Which combination gets you the most buildings without going over \$900,000? Show your working.

2 If you had to move the church no matter what, how much is left, and what else could you afford?

FAST FINISHER

Design your own two-step money problem, work out the answer, then swap with a partner and solve theirs.

Social Studies: Why Towns Are Where They Are

BEFORE YOU READ

Kiruna was built on top of iron ore. Every town is somewhere for a reason. This afternoon is about finding the reason.

- 1 Towns are not scattered randomly across a map. Almost every one was put where it is because of something the land there offered.
- 2 **Water** is the oldest reason. People need drinking water, and before trucks and railways the easiest way to move heavy goods was by boat. Look at a map of any country and you will find towns strung along rivers like beads on a thread.
- 3 **Crossings** matter too. Where a river narrows enough to bridge, a town appears, because everyone travelling in that direction has to pass through the same point. A surprising number of English town names end in "ford" for exactly this reason.
- 4 **Harbors** do the same job on the coast. A bay sheltered from storms is worth a great deal, and towns grow around them.
- 5 **Resources** put towns in places nobody would otherwise choose. Kiruna sits inside the Arctic Circle because of the iron ore beneath it. Mining towns, oil towns and timber towns all exist because of what is in the ground or the forest, not because the spot was comfortable.
- 6 **Defense** was once a powerful reason. A hill is hard to attack and easy to watch from, so old towns are often built on high ground with a castle at the top.
- 7 **Flat, dry land** matters more than people expect. Building is cheaper on level ground that does not flood, which is why towns often stop abruptly at the edge of a marsh or a steep slope.
- 8 Here is the interesting part. The original reason often disappears and the town stays. Plenty of towns grew up around a ford that now has a motorway bridge, or a mine that closed sixty years ago. The reason is gone. The town remains, because by then people had built lives there.

WORDS WORTH KNOWING

Harbor a sheltered place where boats can stay safely.

Ford a shallow place where a river can be crossed.

Resource something useful found in the land, like ore or timber.

Relocate to move somewhere else.

TASK 1: MATCH THE REASON

Write the reason each town is where it is: **water, crossing, harbor, resources, defense, or flat land.**

THE TOWN	THE REASON	PAR.
Built around a sheltered bay where ships can anchor safely		
Built on a steep hill with a castle at the top		
Built inside the Arctic Circle, on top of iron ore		
Built where a wide river narrows enough to bridge		
Built along the bank of a river, stretched out in a line		

1 Think about your own town. Write down two reasons you think it might be where it is. There is no wrong answer, but explain your thinking.

TASK 2: THE BIG IDEA

Paragraph 8 says the original reason often disappears and the town stays anyway. Explain why a town does not just move or empty out when its reason is gone. Use Kiruna in your answer if it helps.

FAST FINISHER

Design your own town on a blank map. Draw a river, a hill and a coast, then mark where you would build and write one sentence saying why.

End of Day Reflection

LAST TEN MINUTES

BEFORE YOU PACK UP

Fill this in on your own. Your teacher will read it tomorrow, so be honest. There are no wrong answers here.

1 One thing I learned today was...

2 One thing I found tricky was...

3 One thing I would tell someone about my own town is...

4 Something my teacher should know about today:

This is for anything at all. Good or bad.

A NOTE TO WHOEVER IS READING THIS

Thank you for looking after our class today. Please write your name here so we know who to thank:

Answer Key: Literacy

READING QUESTIONS

1. Kiruna sits on one of the largest iron ore deposits in the world. **The mine came first**, in 1900, and the town was built around it for the miners and their families.

The order matters. Students who say the town came first have missed the point of the whole passage.

2. Digging out huge amounts of rock made the ground above the mine crack and sink. Engineers measured it and found the cracks heading toward the town. It was slow but certain, and there was no way to stop it.

3. Close the mine, which employed most of the town, or move the town. They chose to move the town.

4. Because moving a building is far more expensive than replacing it.

5. That those buildings mattered to the town for reasons other than usefulness. They were worth the extra cost because a rebuilt copy would not have felt the same.

6. The people who want to stay are right that a home is more than a building: it is a street, a view and a history, and a copy is not the same. The people who back the move are right that the mine is the reason the town exists, and without it there would be no jobs and no town to save.

Full credit needs both sides stated fairly. This question is the whole lesson. A student who only argues one side has not answered it.

GO FURTHER AND WRITING

Go further: Open. There is no correct ranking. Mark the reasoning column, not the order. The most interesting answers come from students who separate *useful* from *important*: a hospital can be rebuilt exactly and work just as well, while a hundred-year-old church cannot.

MARKING THE WRITING IN TEN SECONDS

The one thing to check is whether the other side's point is their strongest or their weakest. Most students pick a weak one because it is easy to knock down. If they did, write "what is their best argument?" in the margin.

IF YOU ONLY MARK ONE THING TODAY

Mark the writing. It is the only piece on the whole day that shows you how each student thinks, and it is the piece the returning teacher can act on fastest.

Everything else can be checked against this key in a few minutes, or simply stacked and left.

Answer Key: Math and Afternoon

MATH PRACTICE

	ANSWER	WORKING
A	\$25.50	$6 \times \$4.25$
B	\$6.55	$\$20.00 - \13.45
1	\$6.25	
2	\$8.25	
3	\$11.00	$5 \times \$2.20$
4	\$4.75	$3 \times \$1.75 = \5.25 , then $\$10 - \5.25
5	\$28.99	$\$38.99 - \10.00
6	\$6.90 each	$\$27.60 \div 4$
7	\$273.00	$28 \times \$9.75$
8	\$100.85 left	$\$186.40 + \$212.75 = \$399.15$, then $\$500 - \399.15

Challenge: **1.** The clock tower, schoolhouse and station together come to \$785,000, which is three buildings and fits. Any combination including the church allows only two. **2.** After the church there is \$480,000 left, enough for the clock tower (\$185,000) plus the schoolhouse (\$260,000), which is \$445,000 in total, leaving \$35,000.

AFTERNOON BLOCK

Task 1: Sheltered bay = **harbor** (par. 4). Steep hill with a castle = **defense** (par. 6). Arctic iron ore = **resources** (par. 5). River narrows enough to bridge = **crossing** (par. 3). Along a river bank = **water** (par. 2).

Q1. Open. Mark the reasoning, not the accuracy. Any answer that names a real feature of the local area and connects it to a sensible reason earns full credit.

Task 2. Because by then people have built lives there: homes, schools, jobs, friends and family. Moving a whole community is enormously expensive and difficult, which is exactly why moving Kiruna was such a big decision and took over twenty years.

LEAVE THIS FOR THE TEACHER

Stack the day's work on the desk with the End of Day Reflection sheets on top. Those are the most useful thing the returning teacher will read.

Time Filler Bank

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE. YOU WILL NEED IT.

WHY THIS PAGE EXISTS

An elementary day is full of gaps: five minutes before specials, ten minutes because lunch ran late, the twenty minutes after everyone finishes early. Those gaps are where a class you do not know falls apart.

Nothing below needs any equipment at all. No photocopies, no board, no supplies.

Under five minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
Twenty questions	You think of an object in the room. They ask yes or no questions. Cap it at twenty and count out loud.
Categories	Name a category (things that are cold, animals with four legs). Go around the room, no repeats. Sit down when you cannot think of one.
Silent line-up	Line up in birthday order, or alphabetical by first name, without speaking. Harder and quieter than it sounds.
Would you rather	Would you rather be able to fly or be invisible? Hands up for each. Ask two children why.
Buzz	Count around the room. Every multiple of three, say buzz instead of the number. Start again at any mistake.

Five to fifteen minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
The one-minute story	You give three words. Each child writes a story using all three, in one minute exactly. Read two or three aloud.
Guess my rule	Sort children into two groups by a secret rule (wearing laces, has a brother). They guess the rule.
The alphabet challenge	In pairs, name something in the room for every letter. First to reach M wins. Nothing needs writing down.
Two truths and a lie	Each child writes three statements about themselves, one false. Partners guess. Excellent for a class that does not know you.
Story chain	You start a story with one sentence. Each child adds one sentence around the room. Absurd is fine.
Estimation station	How many steps from the door to the window? Everyone estimates, writes it down, then you count together. Genuinely mathematical.
Draw what I say	Describe a simple picture out loud. They draw it without seeing it. Compare at the end. Teaches listening and it is very funny.

If you have longer than fifteen minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
Class newspaper	In groups, produce a one-page newspaper about today. Reporters, an illustrator, a headline writer. Absorbs a whole class.
Design a country	Each child invents a country: name, flag, one law, one food, one thing it is famous for. Share three at the end.
Silent debate	Write a statement on the board (homework should be banned). Children write agreements and disagreements on paper passed around, without speaking at all.

TWO RULES FOR ANY OF THESE

Say how it ends before it starts, and **do not offer a choice**. Pick one, announce it, run it. Asking thirty children what they would like to play turns a calm ten minutes into a difficult twenty.

Brain Breaks and Transitions

SUBSTITUTE · KEEP THIS PAGE

WHEN TO USE ONE

Children in grades 3 to 5 can concentrate for roughly as many minutes as their age, plus a little. A brain break every twenty to thirty minutes is not lost time. It is what buys you the next twenty.

Signs you need one right now: fidgeting, chairs tipping, three children asking to use the bathroom in a row, or the same question being asked twice.

Sitting down, two minutes

BREAK	WHAT TO DO
Ten and ten	Ten slow shoulder rolls backward, then ten forward. Everyone stays seated.
Follow the leader	You tap a rhythm on the desk; they copy. Get gradually more complicated.
Silent count to twenty	The class counts to twenty aloud, one number per child, no order agreed and no two speaking at once. Start again on a clash. Remarkably absorbing.
Five deep breaths	In for four counts, out for six. Genuinely calms a room before a written task.

Standing up, three to five minutes

BREAK	WHAT TO DO
Simon says	Works from grade 3 to grade 5 without fail. Speed it up to make it harder.
Four corners	Name the corners 1 to 4. Call a number, everyone moves. Call them faster.
Freeze dance, no music	You clap a beat, they move; you stop, they freeze. No equipment needed.
Stretch and reach	Reach up for ten, touch toes for ten, twist left and right for ten.
Cross-body taps	Right hand to left knee, left hand to right knee, twenty times. Crossing the midline genuinely helps students refocus.

GETTING THEM BACK

Always announce how it ends before it starts. "When I raise my hand, we are back in our seats and ready." A brain break without a stated ending is just noise you now have to fix.

Indoor Recess Bank

SUBSTITUTE • FOR THE DAY IT RAINS

INDOOR RECESS IS THE HARDEST PART OF A COVER DAY

The children expect free time, you do not know the rules, and the room is not designed for it. Pick **one** activity from below, announce it clearly, and run it for the whole period. Offering choices is what turns indoor recess into chaos.

Whole class, no equipment

GAME	HOW IT WORKS
Heads down, thumbs up	Four children are chosen. Everyone else puts heads down, thumb up. The four each press one thumb. Those chosen guess who picked them. Quiet, and they will play it for forty minutes.
Silent ball	Roll or gently pass a soft object. Anyone who speaks or drops it sits out. Requires almost nothing from you.
The detective game	One child leaves. The class picks a leader who starts actions everyone copies. The detective returns and works out who the leader is.
Charades by table	Tables take turns acting out an animal, a sport or a job. Keep it to twenty seconds each.
Hangman or word ladders	On the board. Let a child run it while you supervise. They enjoy it far more than you running it.

At desks, quieter

- **Drawing challenge.** Draw the classroom from the ceiling looking down. Genuinely difficult and absorbing.
- **Paper only.** Fold and design a paper airplane, but no throwing until the last five minutes, outside if allowed.
- **Word building.** Write a long word on the board and see how many smaller words they can make from its letters.
- **Dots and boxes, or noughts and crosses.** In pairs, on scrap paper. Unfashionable and completely reliable.

TWO RULES TO STATE AT THE START

Everyone stays in the room, and when you raise your hand the game stops instantly. Say both before you start, not after something goes wrong.

Fast Finisher Menu

COPY THIS PAGE FOR STUDENTS

FINISHED ALREADY?

Choose any box below. You do not need to ask permission and you do not have to do them in order. Use the back of this sheet or a piece of scrap paper.

TRY THIS

- 1 Write a letter to your teacher telling them what happened today. Include one thing that went well and one thing that was tricky.
- 2 Invent a new animal that lives somewhere very cold. Draw it and label four things that help it survive.
- 3 Write the numbers 1 to 20 down the side of a page. Next to each one, write a multiplication that makes it. Some are impossible with whole numbers. Which ones?
- 4 Design a machine that does one boring job for you. Draw it, label the parts, and write one sentence saying how it works.
- 5 Write a story that is exactly six sentences long. Beginning, middle and end.
- 6 Look around the room and find five things shaped like a rectangle. Estimate the area of each one, then say which estimate you are least sure about.
- 7 Write ten questions you would ask someone who lived a hundred years ago.
- 8 Choose a word with at least eight letters. How many smaller words can you make from its letters? Beat twenty.
- 9 Draw a map of the route from your classroom to the school gate. Label five things along the way.
- 10 Write down three things you are genuinely good at, and one thing you would like to get better at this year.

STILL FINISHED?

Read your book quietly, or help someone at your table who is stuck. Helping means asking them questions, not giving them the answer.

Substitute's Note Back

SUBSTITUTE • FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU LEAVE

THREE THINGS, THEN YOU ARE DONE

1. Stack the day's work on the teacher's desk with the End of Day Reflection sheets on top.
2. Name two or three children who genuinely helped. Teachers act on this, and the children find out.
3. Write one line about anything the teacher should know. One line. Not a report.

NOTE BACK TO THE TEACHER

My name _____

Day taught

Day 1 / Day 2 / Day 3

We got through

All of it / Most of it / The morning only

What we did not reach _____

Children who helped _____

Anything you should know

One line is plenty _____

Would I come back?

Yes, gladly / Yes / Probably not, and here is why: _____
_____**A NOTE TO THE RETURNING TEACHER**

The most useful thing in the pile is not the worksheets. It is the stack of End of Day Reflection sheets, where each child has written what they learned, what was tricky, and anything you should know. Read those first. They take four minutes and they will tell you more about the day than any of the work.

Standards Alignment

COMMON CORE AND NGSS • GRADES 3-5

Each block is mapped to its primary standard. Because the pack spans a grade band, standards are given at grade 4 and apply with light adjustment across 3 to 5.

DAY	BLOCK	FOCUS	STANDARD
1	Reading	Citing evidence from informational text	RI.4.1, RI.4.3
1	Writing	Opinion writing with reasons and evidence	W.4.1
1	Math	Multiplication, arrays and area	3.MD.C.7, 4.MD.A.3
1	Science	Structure, function and survival	4-LS1-1
2	Reading	Cause and effect in informational text	RI.4.3, RI.4.5
2	Writing	Explanatory writing with linking words	W.4.2
2	Math	Perimeter, and perimeter versus area	4.MD.A.3
2	Science	Forces, structures and engineering design	3-PS2-1, 3-5-ETS1-2
3	Reading	Inference and character in literature	RL.4.1, RL.4.3
3	Writing	Narrative writing with descriptive detail	W.4.3
3	Math	Fractions, comparison and reading data	4.NF.A.2, 4.MD.B.4
3	Science	The water cycle	5-ESS2-1

Also practiced every day

- Reading fluency and vocabulary in context, through the morning word work
- Multiplication and division fact recall, through the morning number warm-up
- Reflection and self-assessment, through the End of Day Reflection sheet

A NOTE ON STANDARDS

These are complete instructional days, not curriculum coverage. They are designed to be genuinely useful on a day the regular teacher is absent, without depending on where a class has reached in its own sequence. Every day stands alone.

Standards references are provided to help teachers document the day's instruction. This resource is independently created and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or reviewed by any state agency or standards body.

Terms of Use and Credits

THANK YOU

Thank you for buying this pack. It was written by a practicing teacher with more than twenty years in classrooms, and built the way I would want a full day of cover built if I were the one waking up sick at half past five.

If it saved you a morning, a rating on the listing genuinely helps other teachers find it, and earns you credit toward your next purchase.

Getting the most out of this pack

- **Print all three days before you need them.** The whole point is that it works on a morning when you cannot get to school to print anything.
- **Copy each day as one stapled packet.** Twelve student pages per day. Handing out one packet removes most of the transitions where an unfamiliar class comes apart.
- **Store it in two piles.** Student packets in one, the Day at a Glance pages, scripts and answer keys in the other.
- **Fill in the Class Information page once,** at the start of the year, and it works for every absence after.
- **Tell your office where it is.** On a genuine emergency day, the person who needs to find this is not you.
- **Use the filler banks when you are present too.** The brain breaks and indoor recess pages work on any wet Wednesday.

Terms of use

You may: print this pack for your own classroom, as many times as you like, for as many years as you like. Photocopy the student pages freely for your own students and leave the pack for a substitute covering your own class.

You may not: share the file with colleagues, upload it to a school drive, district server, or any public website, resell it, or claim it as your own work. Additional licenses for colleagues are available at a discount on the listing page.

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